



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Clarksburg Classical Academy

School Website: <https://clarksburgclassical.org/>

December 22, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Clarksburg Classical Academy (WV 26301) presents a clearly classical orientation anchored in the Trivium (Grammar, Logic, Rhetoric) and a mission to form virtuous, capable students. Public materials emphasize character formation, virtue, and a civically engaged, well-rounded education, with concrete references to the Trivium, classical texts in ELA, and a four-part instructional model (ACCEL Instructional Model) that centers on teacher quality, extended instructional time, formative assessments, and individualized learning. However, explicit public commitments to Great Books/Great Conversation, liturgical/theological grounding, and full Socratic pedagogy across all grades are less visible. On balance, the school is best classified as SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL, with meaningful classical elements in place but room for fuller alignment with all six classical elements in the public-facing materials.

Key takeaways: - Core classical elements are present: Trivium framing, grammar/logic/rhetoric focus, character education, and a robust teacher-development and assessment framework through ACCEL. Public pages describe the four-part ACCEL Instructional Model (AIM) and a heavy emphasis on higher-order thinking and writing. Evidence includes explicit mention of the Trivium and the AIM components.

- Strength in school purpose and culture: mission statements emphasize transformation, virtue, and a well-rounded formation of students, with explicit language about shaping character and educating the whole person. This supports a CLASSICAL orientation in spirit, albeit not always in the precise vocabulary of the canonical six elements. - Curriculum and pedagogy show strong classical signals (Grammar/Logic/Rhetoric; classical texts in ELA; emphasis on formation). However, there is less explicit public articulation of Great Books/the Great Conversation, liturgical/theological grounding, or full Socratic seminar practice across all grades in the publicly accessible materials. This keeps the rating in the "Somewhat Classical" range rather than "Classical" for several categories.

- Parent and community engagement is foregrounded (family partnership, community integration, open campus language, calendar of events, etc.), aligning with the classical ideal of parents as co-educators and active community participants. This supports a CLASSICAL rating in category 6.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

- Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
 - Evidence: The site emphasizes virtue and moral formation via Character Education and a morally instructed educational culture, but does not routinely foreground theology, liturgy, or liturgical practices in public material.
 - Positive keyword indicators present: virtue, character, moral formation. Negative indicators: not evident in public materials (no explicit liturgical/theological language).
 - Why this rating: Strong emphasis on virtue and character exists, but explicit transcendental/moral realism language (truth/goodness/beauty as real and knowable; liturgical practices) is not clearly present in public pages. Thus: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.
- Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
 - Evidence: Public statements center on formation and transformation (e.g., "Our mission is to transform the lives of our students, families, and educators..." and callouts to virtue, character, and a well-rounded education). Less emphasis on job-preparation as the primary aim; more

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- emphasis on formation.
 - Positive keyword indicators present: formation, virtue, human flourishing, liberal education, well-rounded education. Negative indicators: explicit emphasis on “workforce preparation” or career-readiness is not foregrounded in public materials. □filecite□turn1file val□
 - Why this rating: The school expresses formation-focused aims and a liberal-arts temperament, but the canonical phrases around true/good/beautiful and the full classical telos are not consistently foregrounded in the site copy. SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.
 - Element 3: Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
 - Evidence: Trivium framing is explicit (Grammar, Logic, Rhetoric). ELA blends classical texts with grammar/vocabulary/writing; electives and character education are highlighted; some historical/cultural integration is implied via a classical approach. Signaling presence of Seven Liberal Arts and Great Books is not consistently explicit in public pages.
 - Positive keyword indicators present: grammar, logic, rhetoric; classical texts; Great Books (not consistently stated) and “Great Conversation” language is not prominent in public site pages. Negative: limited explicit Great Books/Great Conversation across the public material; lack of explicit Quadrivium/Latin emphasis appears in the public content.
 - Why this rating: Strong Trivium signals and classical ELA approach support CLASSICAL sensibilities, but lack of clear Great Books/Great Conversation articulation (and sometimes absence of explicit history-as-social-studies framing) yields SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.
 - Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
 - Evidence: The school emphasizes the ACCEL Instructional Model (AIM) with four components (standards-based curriculum, properly certified teachers, more time on task, short-cycle assessments). The classical pedagogy signals (recitation/memory; Socratic/dialectic in upper grades) are not strongly evidenced in public content; lower-grade singing/memory pedagogy is not explicitly described on public pages, though there is a focus on memory and structure in some classical literature of the six elements.
 - Positive keyword indicators present: Grammar/Logic/Rhetoric; AIM components (explicit in site). Negative indicators: lack of explicit public mention of Socratic seminars, contemplative Scholē, or heavy memorization/recitation in public copy.
 - Why this rating: The AIM framework and classical framing are present, but explicit public articulation of Socratic pedagogy, Scholē-style restfulness, and memory practices is not consistently shown in the site copy. SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.
 - Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL
 - Evidence: Public materials reference Head of School and a professional development/mentorship orientation; ACCEL materials describe teachers as properly certified/licensed and supported by mentors; “living curriculum” and teacher portraits appear in related materials.
 - Positive keyword indicators present: model teachers, mentors, living curriculum, portrait of teacher, collegial culture, professional development. Negative indicators: none evident in public materials.
 - Why this rating: Strong alignment with classical-faculty ideals (model teachers, mentorship, living curriculum) is evident in the publicly available materials. CLASSICAL.
 - Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL
 - Evidence: The school emphasizes partnership with families, parental involvement, community integration, open campus, and events; calendar and board communications show ongoing parental and community engagement.
 - Positive keyword indicators present: partnership with families, parent formation, home-school collaboration, community integration, open campus, parental engagement. Negative indicators: none in public materials.
 - Why this rating: The site demonstrates a robust emphasis on parent involvement and community, aligning closely with classical expectations for Parents & Community. CLASSICAL.
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Aggregate assessment: Across the six categories, Clarksburg Classical Academy WV 26301 exhibits a strong classical orientation in several categories (Faculty; Parents & Community) and clear classical elements in Curriculum and Pedagogy, with formation-focused aims evident in School Purpose and Goal and some Religious/Metaphysical signals. Taken together, the school lands in SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL overall, with solid CLASSICAL signals in at least two categories (Faculty and Parents & Community) and meaningful but not always fully explicit classical commitments in the other categories.

What would move the needle (for SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL)

- Explicitly foreground Great Books and the Great Conversation in the Curriculum category, including a stated plan to engage primary sources and canonical works across grades, and how these intersect with history, philosophy, and literature.
- Add explicit references to Socratic seminars or dialectic in upper grades, and describe concrete Pedagogy practices that align with scholé/restful learning and contemplative study, when appropriate.
- Strengthen Religious/Metaphysical Foundations in public statements (even for non-religious but philosophically oriented classical programs) by clearly naming transcendental aims (truth, goodness, beauty) and, where relevant, liturgical or communal practices that support formation of character and virtue.
- Expand explicit articulation of the Seven Liberal Arts (including Quadrivium and Latin/Greek where applicable) in Curriculum, showing how these disciplines structure the program beyond grammar/logic/rhetoric.
- Maintain and enhance Parent & Community programming by adding more structured parent-education offerings (classical book studies, parent seminars on classical education, etc.) to deepen the co-teacher model.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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